

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Artie Ficial

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with **Claire O'Scuro**. **Claire** keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theatre.
- Relies on **Monet Bags** for the budget and **Sue Venir** for donor agreements.
- Trusts **Brie DeVivre** to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Artie Ficial. It is my pleasure to welcome you to our gala unveiling our newest exhibition, Treasures of the World, sponsored by our generous benefactor, Grant Larceny, who will arrive here shortly. I'm confident this will be a remarkable evening, and if anything goes wrong tonight, please treat it as an immersive experience.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Artie Ficial

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Your other secret

You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Monet Bags has seen the governance addendum.
- Quietly learn whether Claire O'Scuro would stay if you left.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *The moving-picture gallery has a secret on its unseen side.*
- 2 *Success stands on a pedestal. Tonight the prize is underneath the prize.*
- 3 *A lamp dressed in green is illuminating the neighbourhood of a secret.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant wanted my resignation, his name above the door and veto power over every purchase. I had another offer. At 6:39 I took the recruiter's call on the boardroom speakerphone and stayed until 6:45. I accepted. Kindly allow me to tell my trustees before the caterer tells them.

IF MURDERER

Grant wanted my resignation and veto power over every purchase. I had another offer, but announcing my departure under his conditions would have handed him the museum. The recruiter rang during preparations. I let the boardroom line take the call; I had a donor to manage before discussing another job.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I left Grant's speech cards in the salon before six-thirty. Then I borrowed the boardroom for what I called a budget discussion. It was a job interview. After the call I went back to the gallery, where everyone wanted a photograph and nobody wanted responsibility for the naming agreement.

IF MURDERER

I delivered Grant's speech cards before six-thirty and returned to the gallery. Around 6:42 I was checking the dedication wording on the working copy at the reception desk. He had complained about his name twice. Later I went to the boardroom to deal with the waiting recruiter.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the draft resignation from Grant's folder. He had left a space for my signature beneath a date he had chosen himself. The dedication card and naming agreement were still in the folder; I took the page concerning my job. My acceptance of the other directorship is signed. His agreement is not.

IF MURDERER

I tore the draft resignation out of Grant's folder and retained his dedication card. If you have found a sheet with my name and an empty signature line, that is mine. He expected me to supply the stationery for my own dismissal. The board had not approved the naming agreement he meant to announce.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS



Artie Ficial

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed my new appointment, not a murder. The recruiter's retained call places me at the fixed boardroom speakerphone throughout the contamination interval. I took the resignation page because I refused to have my dismissal displayed beside the bowl. I shall answer to the trustees for that, preferably after dessert.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I let the recruiter leave a message. While I should have been answering, I took toxin from conservation and wiped Grant's empty coupe with museum linen. The speech cards got me into the salon. I claimed I was fussing over his dedication at reception. I wanted him gone before he could turn my resignation into his victory.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.